



◁ Typical melodic fragment in 12-bar blues

A typical blues melody over the 12-bar blues pattern is based on the notes of the chord. In blues songs, chromatic (“blue”) notes and melisma—singing more than one note to a single syllable—are used to heighten the sense of pain or sadness in the lyrics.

Syncopation

Jazz uses off-beat rhythms known as syncopation. When written, these can look very complicated, but jazz musicians perform these complex syncopations instinctively as they improvise, putting the emphasis on an unexpected part of the beat.

▽ Syncopation

Syncopation adds rhythmic confusion, which can disorientate the listener’s ear, by shifting the emphasis from the main part of a beat to a subordinate part.



Swing

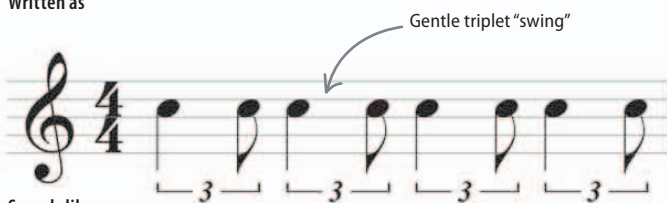
A form of medium-fast jazz developed in the USA in the 1930s, swing has four beats in a measure, and a characteristically “lilting” rhythm. A swing band normally includes trumpets, trombones, saxophones, clarinets, occasionally a violin and guitar, and a strong rhythm section to anchor the beat.

▽ Swing rhythm

Though the swing beat is normally notated as two eighth notes, the first eighth note of the pair is played longer and more accented than the latter.



Written as

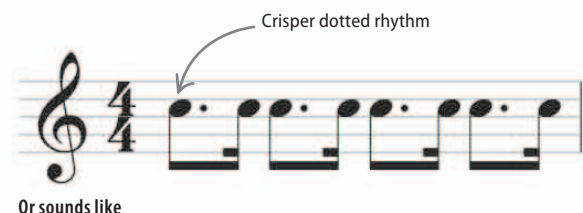


Sounds like

REAL WORLD

Miles Davis (1926–91)

American trumpeter, bandleader, composer, and improviser, Miles Davis was one of the most influential jazz musicians of all time. He was at the forefront of various new forms, including more relaxed “cool” jazz, and “modal” jazz, which was based on modes rather than chords.



Or sounds like